

## » AFTER

**In January 1968, the NVA put their plan into action, taking ARVN and US forces by surprise in towns and cities throughout the South.**

### **POISED FOR ACTION**

By the Vietnamese New Year, more than 320,000 communist troops (fairly equally split between North Vietnamese regulars and Viet Cong guerrillas) were in position for the **Tet Offensive**. Among the peripheral attacks, **Khe Sanh** threatened to be the new Dien Bien Phu.

### **US PUBLIC OPINION WANES**

In February 1968, after **wide criticism of Tet in the US media**, Gallup released a new poll showing that only 32 percent of Americans approved of President Johnson's handling of the war. Secretary of Defense **Robert McNamara resigned** at the end of February. By spring, **Johnson** had decided **not to run for re-election**.